

THE EVOLUTION AND SPIRITUAL MEANING OF MARRIAGE -- NEW AGE MARRIAGE

Blessed are your lives, are all your thoughts, strivings, and endeavors, my dearly beloved friends. Without your deep commitment to live up to your innate potential to be a Godperson, we could never fulfill our own tasks. So we depend on your truth and love, as you depend on ours. We depend on your giving yourselves to the Creator, as you depend on our giving to Him. Let this beautiful mutual work always be blessed anew in the name of the Lord, Jesus Christ.

His name would never elicit so much ambivalence, and often negativity, if divine truth would not have been so distorted in all areas, and also as far as His life on earth and in heaven is concerned. All great divine influxes, powerful energies, and dynamics lend themselves more to distortion than milder forms of creative manifestation. This can easily be observed in your life and with the knowledge you have gained. The great spiritual forces contained in dynamic love are more feared, resisted against, and maligned than lukewarm currents. This is the deepest reason why such stringent taboos existed regarding sexual love, why releasing the spiritual forces seems to be the most threatening and dangerous experiences of all. For these powers are by no means merely ethereal. They encompass all of the personality; they certainly include the body. And this is also why the Christ force, the Christ consciousness, the Christ reality has undergone so much misunderstanding and strife.

It is true that these forces are so strong that an unpurified personality cannot bear them. To the degree negativity and distortion exist in the mind and consciousness of an individual, these powerful currents manifest as crisis, pain, and danger. But being part of these forces, being receptive to them, is the deep longing of every soul -- conscious or unconscious.

In that sense, the development of the institution of marriage is very significant. It needs a deeper insight so that you can widen and deepen your own understanding in this regard and use this knowledge so as to articulate your longing. This is always the first step toward bringing it into actuality. Mankind has undergone development in many areas in the course of the many centuries of its existence. Let us consider some aspects of this development in regard to marriage within the last few centuries. This will give you an idea of the movement that has occurred until now, which, in turn, will open your vision to the ongoing movement that is to occur in the future. It will also make you see the current attitude toward this institution in the light of a larger picture. History can be properly understood only when the spiritual meaning underlying earthly events is gleaned.

In the not too distant past, marriage was entered into primarily as an arrangement that served a number of functions, but least of all the function of sharing, of love, of mutuality on all levels of the personality. In fact, love, mutual sexual surrender, and the profound exchange on dynamic energy levels was rejected and condemned. Marriage was supposed to be a financial and social

contract that served many other personality functions of lower motives. So, for example, financial and social advantages were of primary importance. But what was more significant even than the existence of this fact was the absolute conviction that these motives and reasons were morally right and virtuous. Men married women who brought a good dowry, who raised their social image. In other words, greed and pride were glamorized and endowed with righteousness.

Men considered themselves the superiors over women. Marrying a woman meant nothing more than acquiring a slave who obeyed the master of the house, who saw to it that the man received every comfort and convenience but made no demands for herself in any way. In exchange for these services, which included being an object for man's mostly quite impersonal lust, the woman received material security. She had no other responsibility in life but being an adequate object to her master. Of course you understand, my friends, that this meant much more than mere financial responsibility. Since woman was not considered a full-fledged equal, she was barely morally responsible. The reality of emotional and mental responsibility did not even exist as a concept, but it certainly existed as a fact. This fact was adhered to by men, even without the awareness of the concept, but was totally negated as far as women were concerned.

Obviously this was not only the result of man's distortion and negativity. It was just as much the result of a strongly imbedded intentionality on the part of woman's psyche. Woman negated self-responsibility on all levels for the longest time and therefore cocreated the unequal relationship between the sexes.

Both sexes equally feared -- and still fear -- the powerful spiritual energies involved in the forces of love, eros, and sex between man and woman. This power is the creative stream itself, from which all that is manifest is made. This powerful current can be evoked by different methods, and not only as a binding force between a man and a woman. It can be evoked through spiritual disciplines within an individual, by himself or herself. In that case, it merges the masculine and feminine principles and power currents within an individual soul.

The unpurified soul cannot stand this power current. To the degree unpurified soul substance festers in the personality, the power current has to be denied, suppressed, and split. Sexuality that manifests without love, commitment, and respect is just such a split off, denied power current. When human beings believe that pornographic or promiscuous sex is more pleasurable than the sexuality that streams from a unified wholeness, that combines with love and spiritual union, they could not be more in error. The precise opposite is true. But the power is so strong that it cannot be borne by the soul that still lives partly in darkness.

Another human error is the belief that a decently married couple who are faithful to each other are necessarily beyond the split off sexuality. The kind of typical marriage of former times, as I described it before, was totally an expression of suppression, repression, denial, and split off power currents. In the man, this often manifested in an attitude of not being able to experience strong sexual feelings for the woman who is loved, honored, and respected. Sometimes the unconscious fear of the power current is so strong that the split is total, and a man finds himself unable to experience sexuality with a loved woman. In many cases, however, the split can exist with one and the same woman. He can give relative honor and relative love to a woman whom he has married (this in spite of deeming her inferior), but blot out her reality during the act of sexual union. This act can only be performed when the woman becomes a low object in the mind of the man. So

pornographic sex can manifest within the framework of the respectable marriage that is socially fully accepted.

For the woman, the denial of the unified power current, too strong to bear for the unpurified soul, manifested often in total denial of the sexual reality of her body. And whenever it manifested in spite of all attempts to deny it, it was experienced with guilt and shame.

The misunderstanding about sexual guilt and repression that exist in your world are hardly less pronounced today than they ever were. These repressions and denials, these guilts and false shames were not merely a result of social mores and bigoted influences. The underlying reasons for these is the inability to carry the force of the fully unified power current, whose strength needs an at least relative liberation from negativity, fear, doubt, and destructiveness.

The strongly sexual person, who experiences sexuality without love, without a deeply personal melting with a specifically chosen other, who chooses passing partners without heart and mind -- in other words who is promiscuous -- is essentially no different from the moralist who is faithful to a wife with whom a surreptitious mating takes place as a marital duty. Both are afraid of the love-sex current that has unified through the power of eros, through the power of mutuality in soul development and commitment to each other, through personal purification.

The man-woman relationship of the past and the attitude toward the institution of marriage are a direct result of this fear. Self-purification was practically nonexistent for the average person. It existed only in the churches to any degree of importance. But there, again, the full power was diminished by the edict of celibacy. True, some specially gifted and advanced individuals evoked this spiritual power through their own, separated endeavors. The mystical ecstasy is nothing else but the release of a spiritual power current in which God is experienced as a living and physical reality. This can also ideally happen through the melting of a man and a woman who are sufficiently free from fear, who follow together a path of self-purification. Their union will release this inner power current in which God will be experienced in themselves and each other.

Before discussing this more, let us go back to the evolutionary stages of your history. The picture I painted about marriage is not a very attractive one. Marriage as it existed for so long was truly a more sinful estate than all the sins the moralists who perpetuated these standards condemned. The accusation of sin by these moralists was directed toward illicit sex, toward promiscuous or pornographic sex that could be outwardly detected. It is true that all of these indicated denial of the God-given unification of love and sexuality, of the greatest power current, that is in itself an expression of the divine Presence. So in a certain sense this fear and denial is a symptom of the unpurified soul, the fallen spirit, if you will. But since this unpurified soul state is a fact of evolution and since you all also fulfill a task in the movement of return to the state of Godness, it is futile to launch accusation against this fact, especially since those who do this are themselves part of this fact. They, too, are fallen spirits, are unpurified souls, are part of this evolutionary movement. So the appropriate attitude toward fear of the full power current is one of acceptance of this fact of life; of gentle training so that the personality can gradually acclimatize itself to this high-powered force and bear it in comfort. The ecstasy can and will become comfortable as the soul grows in stature. This happens through the process of development over many, many incarnations.

The real sinfulness of the attitude toward marriage I described, and that prevailed not long ago, existed by virtue of the secondary guilt involved here. Instead of admitting the fear of loving an equal, man had to put down the woman. Instead of admitting the fear of loving an equal and experiencing the pleasure of sexuality, woman had to alienate herself from the man by making him the enemy. Instead of admitting that man feared an equal relationship, he had to make woman an object. Instead of admitting the fear of self-responsibility on all levels, woman made herself an object and then blamed man exclusively for this mutual creation. Both sexes denied the fear -- which might be called, in a much deeper sense, the primary guilt, a guilt that all mankind shares. But the denial of the fear could only occur by secondary guilts. Some of these secondary guilts were giving energy to impulses of the lower self. So material greed accrued. Money, power, social advantages played into motives for choosing mates. Public images, appearance values, idealized self images were nourished; pride and vanity were elevated into moralistic false values. If you consider the moral indignation, the moral self-righteousness of men and women toward those who deviated from the accepted standards then, you see the strength of the secondary guilt. The mask self did not even pretend to be something genuinely good and valuable. The mask self claimed greed, calculating self-interest, prideful appearance values, and mutual using each other as the highest moral standards. This goes way beyond ordinary hypocrisy. This kind of hypocrisy was so deep-rooted and so pernicious that it required a strong uprooting in order for the soul to heal. It is important, my friends, that you see the nature of the attitude toward marriage as it existed for many, many centuries. People marrying for love were the great exceptions.

The collective state of consciousness created these conditions. This same collective state of consciousness also created karmic conditions, prerequisites for specific guidances for ensuing reincarnations. For example, the antagonism that generally existed between men and women had to manifest specifically between individual men and women to a much greater degree than is the case now. So it was often "predestined" that two such individuals had to meet as prospective marriage partners. Their elders would arrange it. This kind of union gave the scope to bring general and specific negative feelings and attitudes to consciousness which, in turn, is the basis for transformation. Thus, my friends, the "marriages made in heaven" were by no means always positive unions of love and affection, of attraction and respect. The negative mutuality between many, many individual men and women created the collective consciousness, created karmic conditions, and created the then existing standards of society.

In very recent times, consciousness has made a great leap in development. It has truly become ready to shed these old attitudes and create new conditions, new standards, new moral values. This can clearly be seen in your times by many drastic changes. The women's liberation movement, the sexual liberation movement, and a very different attitude toward marriage are clearly signs of a newly emerging consciousness. These manifestations must be viewed in the light of an overall movement, an evolutionary direction, in order to really grasp the inner meaning of all these changes.

In all evolutionary movements, there is always the swinging pendulum, tending to go from one extreme to another. This is sometimes inevitable, sometimes even desirable, provided it only goes up to a degree into an exaggerated direction. But when the degree becomes more than necessary or desirable, fanaticism and blindness evolve in exactly the same way as the opposite direction from which the pendulum swung away.

So, for example, the sexual freedom today is a reaction to the shackles of former times. To a degree this is a necessary phase individuals may have to experience temporarily until the wisdom of the new consciousness completes itself in which commitment to one mate is a freer and more liberated and infinitely more desirable act than the uncommitted, free floating exchange of partners. The cycle had to move from involuntary monogamous commitment with accompanying infringements of personal unfoldment (for both men and women), to an awakening of the debilitating state of this attitude and a consequent liberalism and polygamous expression, to a new groundedness in real inner freedom and independence that voluntarily chooses the monogamous commitment because it yields infinitely more satisfaction, gratification, and fulfillment.

In the old attitude toward marriage, a particularly pernicious aspect was that the sexual need, as well as the need for companionship, was polluted by subjecting these needs to opportunistic, materialistic, and exploitative ends. Whenever one soul current is put secretly into the service of another, both become negative. If love, eros, and sex would be given their rightful place, the real need for success, for respect from the community, for material abundance could function in a higher self way. The fact that this pollution and displacement was looked at as if this were the morally more desirable attitude was even worse. So mankind had to break away from all this, and this perforce had to create a certain amount of upheaval. So the sexual revolution had to manifest at times in undesirable ways -- but undesirable only when seen out of context. Individually the true lesson must be learned, though. This lesson is exactly what I am saying here. The old ways desperately need profound change. A new sexual expression and joyful acceptance of the sexual drive has to emerge. At the same time, individual men and women need to understand the enormous importance of the wholeness of love, eros, and sex; of affection and respect; of tenderness and passion; of trust and mutual partnership; of sharing and helping each other. It must be understood that the committed relationship is not a moralized edict that deprives you of pleasure. Quite, quite the contrary is true. It must be understood that the power current evoked through a fusion between love, respect, passion, sexuality is infinitely more ecstatic than any casual fusion could ever be. In fact, it is so powerful that the very authorities against whom so much rebellion is launched have feared this combined current more than anyone. These same authorities are essentially not that far removed from him who allows himself to experience sexuality only in a split off way -- cut off from the heart, removed from real intimacy and sharing.

Knowing the state into which you can grow, no, must eventually grow into, because this is your innate destiny, is important. It is the blueprint without which you cannot steer your ship. But there is a subtle and yet distinct difference between this model that beckons, on the one hand, and a forceful attempt to be what you have not yet organically grown into, on the other. In the former way, you accept your human state. You know that by virtue of your humanness, you cannot immediately be the ideal, totally fused individual. You know that it takes a long time, much experience, many lessons, many trials and errors, untold incarnations until your soul substance has emerged to become this whole being. You need to know that such a state exists, even if you are still quite unable to experience it. You need to know it without self-pressure, without self-moralizing, without discouragement. All of these attitudes are destructive and erroneous.

The attempt to enforce an ideal state that individuals cannot possibly live up to at this time has unfortunately been practiced by almost all organized religions. This is why organized religion has fallen into ill repute today. The state of wholeness should be placed lightly into your

consciousness, if I may use this expression. It should never become a whip. It should merely be a reminder of who you essentially already are and who you will one day become.

Just as it is foolish to turn into an atheist because of the errors of religion, so it is foolish to discard marriage altogether because of its previous distortions. Before marriage began to be doubted as a valid institution by a variety of individuals, the attitude toward this institution had already begun to change considerably in the last several decades. As opposed to the past, individuals chose partners freely and generally were motivated by love. However, this also often led into erroneous solutions. Only too often, individuals who were too young and immature to form a really meaningful union, chose marriage, based on superficial attraction and without deeper knowledge of self and the other. No wonder that this type of marriage could not survive. But this step, too, had to be gone through before maturity could grow. Just as individuals cannot learn unless they experience their mistakes and immaturities, collective consciousness has to do the same. New ways have to be tried out before the soul reaches wisdom and truth. The freedom to choose independently, the freedom to experience sexual and erotic pleasure, the freedom of making mistakes and learning from them, the freedom of growing into different and more mature relationships along with the growth of the self without condemnation -- all of these are necessary prerequisites to learn the real significance of marriage; to see it, not as a shackle imposed by a moralizing outer or inner authority, but as a freely chosen gift, the greatest, most desirable state imaginable, the keenest pleasure and fulfillment for which the soul and the personality have to become strong, resilient, mature, capable of carrying the power to these energies. Bliss, ecstasy, pleasure supreme can never exist gratuitously, cheaply snatched. They cannot be borne that way. They can only be borne when the personality has reached sufficient purification, security, faith, self-knowledge, comprehension of the universe, Christness.

Sexual liberation has to go through some stages that may seem exaggerated, or may even be exaggerated, before further sexual liberation -- the unification of love, eros, and sex -- can create the new age marriage. Fleeting sexual encounters should not be looked upon as the final state of liberation. It is, at best, a very temporary and limited phase to go through. No one who has ever experienced it has ever truly been satisfied by it, not even on the merely physical level. You may delude yourself that it is the best you could hope to experience, but it is not. You may deny your deeper unfulfilled longing because some of the hitherto unfulfilled longing is now assuaged. But it is only a small part, and you have so much further to go in order to give yourself what you really need, want, desire, and what you should indeed have.

Similarly as with the sexual revolution, so the feminine liberation had to go into some kind of extreme, at least temporarily. So some women had to become as hard, as unyielding as their greatest enemy, the man, in order to experience their strength, their capacity to be independent, self-responsible, creative, and resourceful. As long as this is a temporary manifestation, a passing phase, an interim phase from which further changes will emerge, it is all right. But when this is seen as the final ideal, it becomes as damaging as the suppressed and dependent child woman you no longer want or need to be. The new age woman combines independence, self-responsibility, full-fledged adulthood with the softness and yieldingness that was previously associated exclusively with the dependent parasite. The new age man combines his heart feelings, his softness, his gentleness, with his strength and abilities, not in a similar, but in a complementary way. The two can form the new age marriage.

The new age marriage will not be formed early in life. If the participants are young, they will have reached a considerable maturity as a result of genuine, intense pathwork such as this. The new age marriage is a nucleus of strength, fortifying each other in the common voyage and also fortifying others in a commonly undertaken task for the greater cause. The new age marriage is totally open and transparent. There are no secrets whatever. The soul process of the pathwork is totally shared. This openness and transparency needs to be learned. It is a path within the path, as it were. You need to expose your difficulty in achieving this openness, rather than denying or hiding it. If you do not do so, your unfulfillment cannot be alleviated no matter how much you may try to blame it on your partner or on outer circumstances. Part of this openness is the revealing of the fear of the strong spiritual current, the forces released by the unification of sexuality and the heart. When the fear is shared, even while both may be unable to shed the fear as yet, the obstructions are being eliminated relatively fast. And some kind of vibrant fulfillment comes even from this sharing.

In the new age marriage, a path of profound self-development and emptying out of all hidden areas of the self is a prerequisite for fulfillment and for keeping the relationship alive. When the vibrancy ebbs away, this too, needs to be met together and explored. It may have any number of reasons, none of them necessarily bad or shameful.

When all levels of the personality meet, join, are open to each other, and finally fuse, the intensity and vibrancy of the sexual encounter will surpass anything you can at present imagine. You deeply long for this because this fulfillment is your birthright and your destiny. It can only exist in a partnership such as I outline here -- in the new age marriage. This kind of fusion cannot easily come about. It is the result of infinite patience, growth, change, transformation. But it should live in your vision as a possibility you can indeed actualize one day.

The fusion on all levels of the personality means the fusion of all energy bodies. This is very rarely the case. You will come to know when the fusion exists only on the physical level and when on the emotional, the mental, and spiritual levels. All these energy bodies exist as reality and can fuse, or do not fuse, according to prevailing conditions. When the fusion takes place on all these levels, you not only become one with your partner but with God. You realize God in the mate and God in yourself. No wonder that the power current is too strong to bear unless the personalities involved have reached a high degree of inner development and purification.

When it is being realized that sexual fusion is insufficient and uninteresting unless it includes all the energy bodies in the process of coming together, the approach to a sexual encounter will be very different from what it is now. It will never be casual or haphazard. It will be considered a holy ritual. These rituals will be created by the individual couples and may change at different phases. They will never deteriorate into fixed routines. The sexual encounter is a true fusion of the masculine and feminine principles as universal forces. Each sexual fusion will be a creative act, creating new spiritual forms, new heights of development in the two selves that can be given on to others. The merging and complementing of these two divine aspects -- the feminine and masculine forces -- will create not only total fulfillment, ecstasy, and bliss but enduring new values and a true experience of divine reality, of the Christ in the self and in the other.

My beloved friends, this lecture should by no means discourage you, no matter how far away you may seem to be from the possibility and the destiny I outline here. You are moving in this direction merely by being able to comprehend this lecture, by being capable of choosing to use it in

the most positive way no matter where you are. Knowing this truth will free you as any other truth must free you, even if you cannot attain its completion in this life. Rejoice that it exists, that it waits for you. Know this truth as the enrichment which has been given you.

There exists a tremendous tension between the male and female energy currents. This tension can manifest in a positive or a negative way. If it manifests negatively, sexuality is hooked up with denial (homosexuality, repression, asexuality, impotence, frigidity) or with negative expression (sadism, masochism, fetishisms). To a degree, it may be necessary to give some expression to negatively connected sexuality, for if it is completely denied, the total personality is being thwarted, and the tension leads to such powerful accumulation that nonsexual violence accrues. Especially if these expressions occur in fantasy or in situations of mutual consent where no one is harmed or forced, this can be a step leading to a more cohesive, connected sexuality -- especially when this is not being glorified, but understood in its true meaning.

When the tension manifests positively, it is truly a psychic nuclear point. New age marriage is a psychic nuclear point. The energy released, the creativity liberated, the mutuality of ecstasy -- these are deeply spiritual experiences in, through, and with God. Divine sexuality must be recognized in the new age. It is neither to be found in the old taboos and denials, the moralizing judgment of this creative force; nor is it to be found in the deviations that occur by necessity as a result of incomplete development. The explosive force of the male/female tension and release mechanism permeates the total personality and transcends the finite. It truly spiritualizes the body and materializes the spirit, which is the task of evolution.

With this, I bless you, my beloved ones. The Christ within your deepest soul fuses with the Christ consciousness and energies that surround you and fill you with His love, His strength and His blessings.

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